

Inclusive Supports in Education

- **DAY TWO (Part 5)**
- **Education Assistant Program**
- **Instructor: Leonie Stephens**



Agenda

Documentation

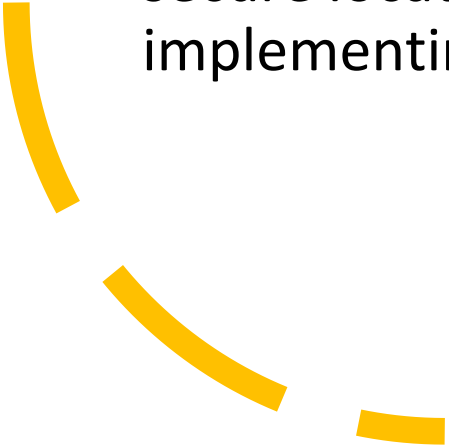
- Student files
- Confidentiality
- FOIPPA
- Storage of materials/information

Service Delivery

- EAs assignment process/planning tool



Documentation – G4

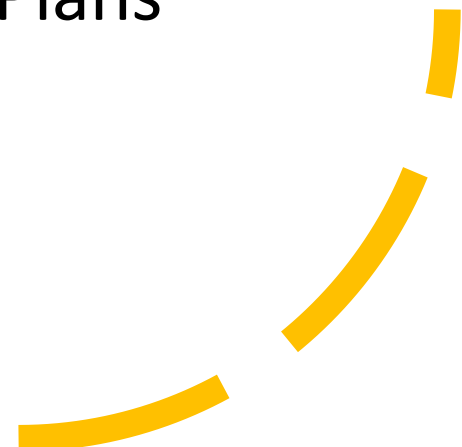
- Every student has their own **General Student File** or **G4 file** that contains their Permanent Record Card, report cards, registration forms, medical alerts and other documentation.
 - **IEPs** are part of the overall G4 file, though they are kept with all other special education documentation in the student's **special education Red File**.
 - The G4 and special education Red File is confidential and needs to be filed in a secure location. Each school, under district direction, is responsible for implementing a file management system for accessing/ reviewing these files.
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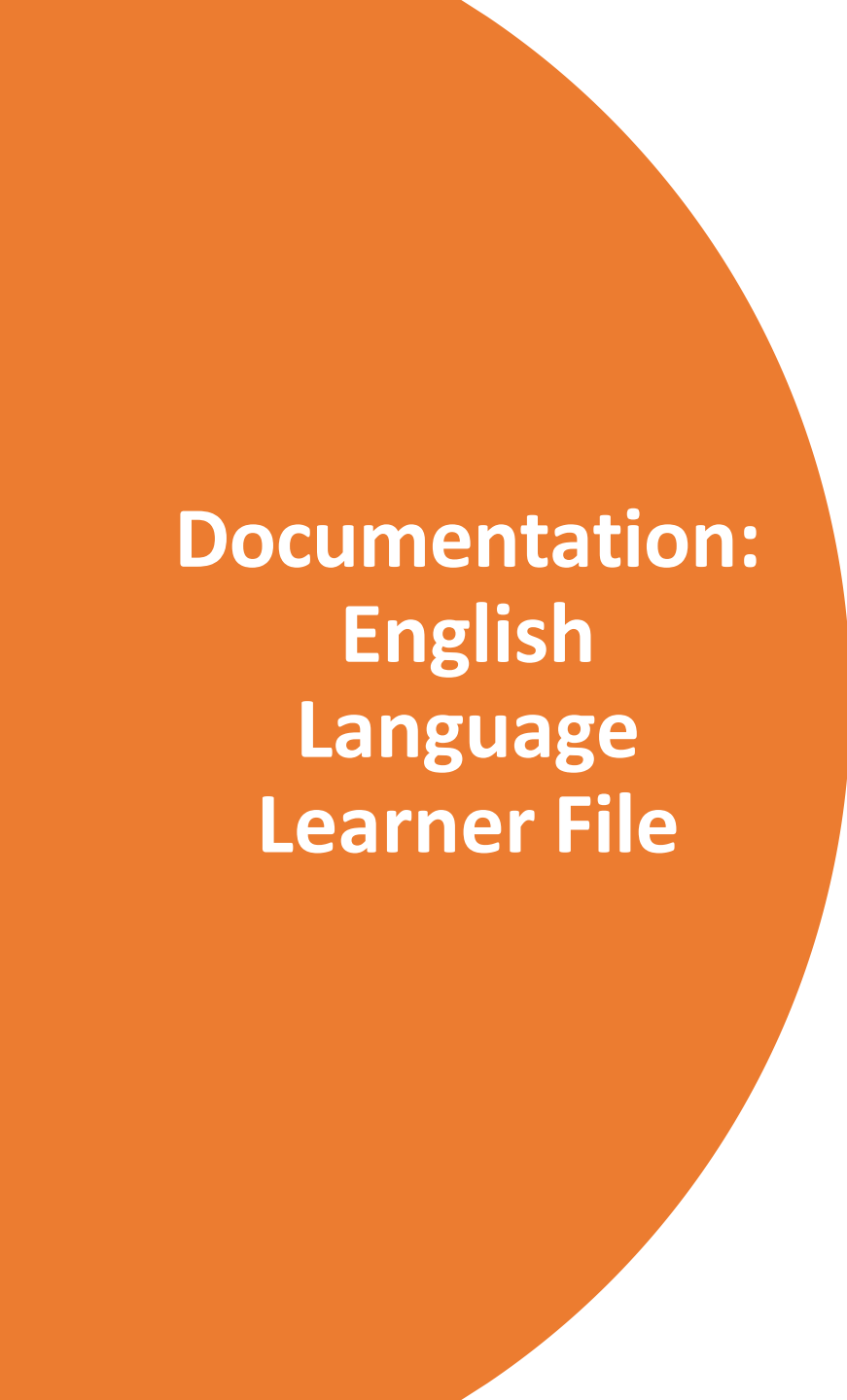
Common Formal School District Files

- G4 File
- Red Special Education File
- English Language Learner files (Yellow/Green – will be different for different districts): This file includes the student's individual assessment data, Annual Instructional Plans (AIPs), individual goals and strategies for intervention
- Aboriginal Education Files (Purple - will be different for different districts): This file includes checklist of necessary documentation for Aboriginal Education funding.

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Documentation: The Red File

- The Special Education Red File includes important confidential information such as:
 - IEPs
 - Original documentation supporting the designation/ diagnosis; e.g. medical reports and assessment reports
 - Level A, B and C assessment reports
 - Medical alerts and health care plans
 - Positive Behaviour Support Plans
 - Staff Safety Plans
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Documentation: English Language Learner File

- English Language Learner Files hold information on students who are designated as English Language Learners (ELL).
 - The Ministry requires specific information to be held in these files for audit purposes. These files are organized in a specific order, and it is important not to change/alter this organization.
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Informal Files



What is an informal file? Who might have one?

- Any collection of student work or information related to a student is considered a file
- An informal file is one held by a staff member for education related reasons
- Resource Teachers, Classroom Teachers, Psychologists, SLPs, Counsellors, Administrators, anyone who works with students
- Students may have work portfolios to collect evidence of progress
- EAs may have a **Substitute Binder** or a Student Binder

EA Substitute Binder

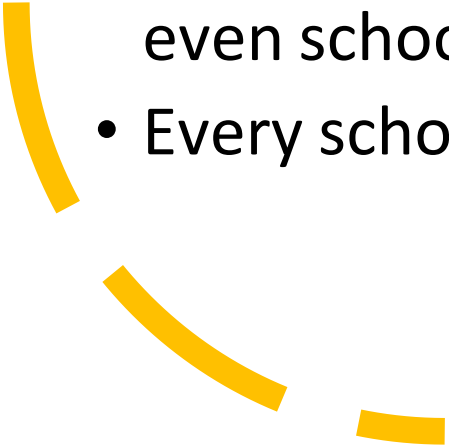
- If you are substituting, you should receive a sub binder or folder which will give you the needed information for the day. If there is no sub folder you need to ask some questions. Hopefully the other EAs will welcome you and help with your orientation.
- When substituting, after arriving, report to the administration in the main office unless otherwise directed. Be early so you have time to orient to the location and the job assignment.
- The administrative assistant/secretary should show you how to sign in, where the Safety Plans are kept, and provide a general Health and Safety orientation specific to the location you are working in. They may also inform you about any parking arrangements. Ask if this is not provided.

EAs also create Subbinder

- When hired and assigned to student(s), EAs to put together a subfile.
- The Substitute Binder may contain information that is private. Be conscious of this when deciding what to write and how to write it (your school team are great resource to help out with this)
- Never write anything private about the student such as personal family information, Family Services Information, or anything of a highly confidential nature
- Never write your thoughts, opinion or conjecture of anything. Only write what is absolutely necessary for a SUB to know in order to support your student in your absence
- The sub binder is to be maintained in a private place in order to support student privacy as well. Be aware that you or your SUB could accidentally leave it lying about
- Never put a student's name or anything that identifies the student on the outside of the binder



Important to Remember

- EAs are never to take anything out of a file or add anything to a file
 - Any file additions or deletions are the responsibility of teachers or administration
 - EAs may be permitted to read files of students they are working with in order to get necessary information to support the job they are doing after receiving permission. This will differ from district to district and even school to school. You must receive permission.
 - Every school will have their own procedures around this
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Caution

- **Never** share information with outside agencies/people
- Requests from outside sources for file information must go to the administration, even when you know the information
- Staff who may access information are those who work with the student only and have permission from administration
- All information is private and confidential



Confidentiality



Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act

Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act

- Sometimes referred to as FIPPA or FOIPPA
- Legislation defines personal information as recorded information about an identifiable individual.
- Purpose is to protect the privacy of individuals with respect to personal information about themselves held by institutions
- Provide individuals with a right of access to that information.

Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act

Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act's provisions include:

- an individual's right of access to his or her personal information
- an individual's right to request correction of his or her personal information
- the public's right of access to records held by public bodies
- prevention of the unauthorized collection, use, or disclosure of personal information by public bodies
- an independent review of decisions made under its authority

Confidentiality

- As EAs, you are expected to maintain the privacy of the students in the school. This means only examining files of those students you work with for the purposes of providing support.
- This information is to be kept confidential and only discussed with other employees who provide support to this student.
- This information is to be discussed in private situations where it cannot be overheard by others.
- Anything held within these files can be requested to be accessed by legal guardians, parents, attorneys or courts. Requests are made to the administrator of the school.
- Be respectful and responsible
- Keep in mind that places such as the main office, around the photocopy machine, the staffroom, and in the classroom are not necessarily private as other staff, students, volunteers, and parents can overhear

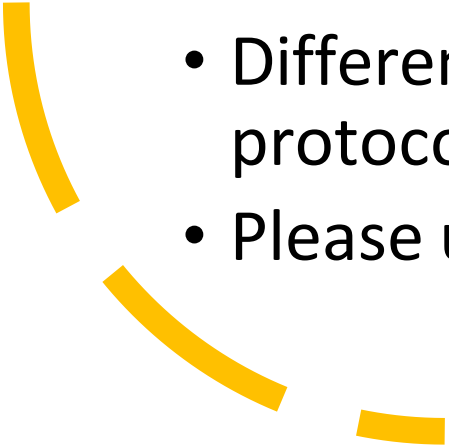
Confidentiality Scenarios

Activity: In pairs, discuss the following two scenarios:

- Scenario A: You are sitting at a crowded Starbucks after work and you run into a new EA who works at your school. You get a table together and he begins to ask you questions about Charlie, a student you support who is having difficulties at the school. What should you do?
- Scenario B: As you are supervising on the playground, a parent approaches you about an incident on the playground that she had 'heard about' involving two specific students. She presses you for information because "this is another example of problem that these two boys create in the school". What should you do?
- Large group sharing.



Administrative Assistant, Clerks, School Secretaries

- The administrative staff, under the direction of the administration, is responsible for the organization and maintenance of files in the office
 - Administrative assistants/secretaries are responsible for cataloging all components of these files into an online storage system and for managing this data while the file is in the school
 - Please understand their perspective and respect how you use the files
 - Different schools and different school levels often have different protocols about who can and how they can access files
 - Please understand and use professional courtesy when using files
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How are student with diverse needs supported in each school/school district?

- How are these supports provided?
- What model is used?



**Service
Delivery**

Service Delivery

Many schools and school districts use a Response to Intervention (RTI) approach. This system is usually used to allocate support & services.

Tier I students receive basic instruction in the classroom (80% of student population).

Tier II students will receive additional small group instruction each day in reading (15% of student population).

Tier III students will receive additional individualized instruction each day in reading. (5% of student population).TI) approach - <http://www.smithton.stclair.k12.il.us/response-to-intervention-rti.html>



RTI (Response To Intervention)
3 Tiers of Support

Service Delivery

Specialized supplemental services may include one or more of the following depending on the level of student need:

- Education Assistants
- Child & Youth Care Workers
- District Learning Support Services Team; e.g.
 - District Speech-Language Pathologist
 - District School Psychologist
 - District Hearing Teacher
 - District Vision Teacher
 - District Occupational or Physiotherapists
 - District Behaviour Support and Intervention Teachers



Service Delivery: How are Education Assistants assigned to schools?

- In some districts, twice a year, the Director of Instruction, Learning Services formally meets with School Based Teams to discuss the level of student need at both the individual student level and school level. These meetings may be referred to as “Registry Reviews”
 - There are also Spring Staffing meetings that occur to project staffing needs for the next school year.
 - The level of individual student need is always the focus
 - Schools may use the Education Assistant Planning Tool that has 3 tiers of support.
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Service Delivery

- Education Assistants are assigned to schools and then the Principal assigns them to specific students.
- It is not uncommon for Education Assistants to be assigned to more than one student in a classroom.

EA Planning Tool

- Hierarchy of Needs
 - Priority #1
 - Priority #2
 - Priority #3
- Level of EA Proximity
 - Level 1
 - Level 2
 - Level 3
 - Level 4
 - Level 5

This is one example of how Education Assistants are allocated. Other districts may use a different model.



EA Planning Tool: Hierarchy of Needs

Priority #1: Health Care

- Basic and essential health care without which a student could not attend school.
 - E.g. basic mobility, seizure management, glucose monitoring etc.
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EA Planning Tool: Hierarchy of Needs

Priority #2: Behaviour, Communication and Self-Help

- Situations where behaviours constitute a danger to the child and others.
- Essential communication needs (including visual supports, symbol mediated communication, gestural signing, use of augmentative communication technology).
- Self-Help needs which may include feeding and hygiene supports, dressing, developing executive functioning etc.



Priority #3: Instructional Support

- Specific instructional interventions for individuals or small groups under the direction of the Classroom and/or Learning Support Teacher.
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EA Planning Tool: Level of EA Proximity

- **Level 1:** EA is elsewhere in the school—called only when needed.
- **Level 2:** EA is in the classroom part of the day—available to assist all students in the room.
- **Level 3:** EA is in the classroom part of the day—assisting specific students with activities such as personal care routines, transitions, task start-up etc.
- **Level 4:** EA is in the classroom most of the day—occasional close proximity (side by side) and ongoing visual monitoring.
- **Level 5:** Ongoing very close physical proximity (side by side).